



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Valor Classical Christian Academy

School Website: <https://www.valorclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Valor Classical Christian Academy (Neenah, WI 54956) presents a robust classical Christian program that is largely CLASSICAL across the core dimensions of a classical education. The public materials emphasize a theology-infused, virtue-centered formation model, continuous integration of biblical truth, and a structure built around the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with explicit attention to Great Books / Great Conversation and a liberal-arts rhythm. The school places strong emphasis on virtue, formation, wisdom, and character, with communal Christian life integrated into learning and school life. Pedagogy includes concrete lower-school practices (singing, memorization, memory work) and upper-school opportunities for reasoning, debate, and rhetoric, aligning with classical expectations. The governance, faculty descriptions, and parent/community engagement also echo classical norms (living curriculum, partnership with parents, and a curriculum map aligned with the Great Conversation). Overall, Valor is CLASSICAL with a clearly stated formation-centric aims and a public presence that emphasizes virtue, truth, and Christian formation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

What would move the needle: For Valor to reach a solid, fully CLASSICAL designation in Element 4, the school could more explicitly document and publicly showcase Socratic seminar-style pedagogy and high-school rhetoric/seminar experiences as a regular, clearly defined element of the upper grades (beyond the Logic School framing). Additional explicit liturgical calendaring or structured communal liturgy on campus could further reinforce Element 1. None of the other six categories require major overhauls to secure a CLASSICAL rating, given the current public materials.

ABSTRACT

: Valor is CLASSICAL overall, with strong religious and metaphysical foundations, a formation-first approach to education, a clearly articulated curriculum rooted in grammar/logic/rhetoric and Great Books, and active parent/community partnership. The one noteworthy area for needle-moving improvement is to more explicitly articulate and publicize high-school-level Socratic pedagogy and rhetoric experiences as a consistent, grade-spanning practice (Element 4).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Valor consistently frames education as Christ-centered, with formation in wisdom and virtue and a Gospel-centred aim (motto: shaping character through enduring education that cultivates wisdom, virtue, and service to Christ). The public materials articulate a Christian worldview and biblical framing as foundational to learning.
- The public materials emphasize “wisdom begins with the fear of the Lord,” truth anchored in God, and being “connected...in Christ,” with a strong theology-infused stance.
- There is explicit mention of partnering with churches and a Christ-centered educational mission; the school operates inside a church facility (Faith Global Methodist Church), with non-denominational, Bible-centered language in communications.
- The school catalog emphasizes Scripture integrated into every aspect of learning and “the ultimate goal that every student would be transformed by the truth of the gospel and serve Christ in all things.”
- Positive emphasis on liturgical and communal rhythm exists via references to worship-appropriate language and communal formation (e.g., church affiliations and liturgical calendar-integration vocabulary in the Classical lexicon; also the “Gre at Festival” style events in Grammar School as communal, ritualized activities).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, beauty, goodness; virtue; wisdom; theology; Christ; gospel; liturgy; worship; catechesis; sacred texts; imago Dei; Logos; creation-based worldview; sacred tradition; doxology; church community; fear of the Lord; scriptural integration; Christian formation; transcendentals (as a concept in the Classical lexicon).
- Negative keywords: None prominent in public materials (no explicit values-neutral, secular-humanist, or relativistic framing observed in public content).

Why this rating

- The materials align with transcendental moral realism and theology in everyday language (truth/goodness/beauty; fear of the Lord; Christ-centered learning). The presence of biblical framing, church affiliation, and explicit Christian formation signals a strong religious/metaphysical grounding, which the classical rubric marks as CLASSICAL when coherently integrated with the instructional approach. The absence of secular or relativistic signals in the public materials supports CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations: We highlight the mission-focused, Christ-centered language and fear-of-the-Lord articulation from Valor’s public materials (Our Approach; Mission and Values).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing as core aims, not merely job preparation. The mission is described as shaping young people through enduring education that cultivates wisdom, virtue, and service to Christ.
- There is explicit reference to the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real ends of education, with a formation-driven telos (paideia framing and Great Conversation references).
- The Great Conversation / Great Books emphasis appears in Valor’s approach to reading and evaluating works through the lens of Christian truth, signaling formation over information.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; telos; Great Conversation; classical heritage; moral imagination; (imperfectly named, but clearly implied through “enduring education” and the Great

Conversation approach).

- Negative keywords present: none (no overt “workforce preparation” or “21st-century skills” framing found in public materials).

Why this rating

- The school presents an explicit formation-centric goal set that centers virtue and wisdom, consistent with CLASSICAL understandings of paideia and the true/good/beautiful telos. The absence of workforce- or career-prep language in the public materials reinforces CLASSICAL classification for this category.

Citations: Evidence of formation/virtue/wisdom and Great Conversation in Valor’s materials.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Valor organizes around the Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric, with explicit references to “Grammar School” (K–6) and “Logic School” (7th–8th) as distinct phases. This alignment to the traditional Trivium is clearly visible in staff materials and curriculum pages.
- Public materials describe a curriculum that emphasizes liberal arts, Great Books / Great Conversation, and integrated study across history, literature, and primary sources; there are explicit references to reading notable works and shaping content to align with Christian truth.
- The Curriculum Map Masterplan / Masterplan (external PDF) is provided publicly, signaling a deliberate map of topics across the three-arts/trivium framework.
- There are explicit mentions of classical content (Latin, literature, history, etc.) in faculty bios and program descriptions (e.g., Logic School content and 7th–8th grade curriculum).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts; grammar; logic; rhetoric; great books; great conversation; history; Latin; classical languages; primary sources; Western civilization; humanities-focused integration; memory work; recitation; chants; sacred text integration.
- Negative keywords present: the public materials do not show project-based learning dominance or STEM-first framing; the lexicon’s negative signals (e.g., replacing history with social studies language) are not present in Valor’s public materials.
- The presence of the explicit Trivium sequence and Great Books signals a CLASSICAL orientation.

Why this rating

- The explicit articulation of grammar/logic/rhetoric, the Great Conversation / Great Books emphasis, and the historical-liberal-arts grounding align with the classical curriculum model.

Citations: Trivium framing and Curriculum Map; Great Conversation emphasis; Latin/Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric in public content.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Lower grades emphasize memory work, chants, singing, and recitation as instructional supports (typical of the grammar stage). Valor explicitly depicts younger students learning through singing, memorization, and memory-based review.
- Upper grades emphasize logic, questioning, and guided inquiry; the Logic School description highlights questions, debate, and pursuing truth, with an emphasis on reasoning and clear communication.
- There are references to seminars and rhetoric training as part of the upper-grade experience (e.g., “logic school,” and rhetoric-focused language in some staff bios). However, explicit, consistent public documentation of formal, repeated Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars across all upper

grades is not uniformly explicit in the public content. The materials do reference Socratic-style activities in the broader classical tradition (public lexicon and contextual materials) but do not always present a tight, current-year, across-grade schedule for Socratic seminars on Valor's site.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: singing; memory work; recitation; chanting; scholé; contemplation; wonder; debate; rhetoric; speeches; logical thinking; great conversation (via public materials and curriculum descriptions).
- Negative keywords present: limited explicit, public documentation of ongoing, school-wide Socratic seminars or Paideia seminars across all grades; no explicit "experiential learning" emphasis in the public materials.

Why this rating

- Valor demonstrates many core pedagogical practices of a classical program (grammar-stage memory/chanting; dialectic-stage questioning and logic; some rhetoric-focused activities). Yet the public-facing, explicit, sustained documentation of a comprehensive Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy across grades 9–12 is not uniformly explicit. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Citations: Grammar-stage memory/chanting content; Logic School description; broader references to classical pedagogy in the public materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The faculty bios portray teachers as experienced, virtue-oriented mentors who model character, engage with students respectfully, and serve as the living curriculum (e.g., principal, teachers with biblical/theological grounding, and a variety of academic backgrounds). The public bios emphasize a commitment to virtue, character formation, and high intellectual/teaching standards.
- The board and governance are explicitly Classical-aligned (board of directors, including many parents and educators with classical Christian education experience, and membership in ACCS and connections to Circe Institute resources). This is also aligned with classical education ecosystems.
- The school highlights a "living curriculum" notion via staff bios that interweave Bible, theology, and classical pedagogy, and the staff are depicted as forming the core of the school community (principal, teachers, and staff with strong subject-matter expertise and faith commitments).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: masters/mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; mentorship; virtue; character formation; biblical/theological grounding; classical pedagogy; teacher training in classical pedagogy.
- Negative keywords present: none observed (no hints of "facilitators" or minimal teacher roles that run counter to classical formation).

Why this rating

- Valor's staffing, leadership, and governance language align with classical ideals of the teacher as mentor and living curriculum, and the board's ties to classical associations reinforce CLASSICAL designation for this category.

Citations: Staff bios and governance language; board affiliations and classical resources.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence



- The school emphasizes partnering with parents to shape hearts and minds biblically, in a co-teaching model that positions parents as co-educators and co-disciplers with teachers. This is directly stated in Mission & Values materials.
- The public materials reference parent formation and engagement opportunities (book studies, gatherings, and family involvement are implied/explicit in the broader classical ecosystem). The site publicly promotes information sessions and tours that involve families and invites parent involvement in admissions and school activities.
- The school explicitly notes that families are welcomed to visit; the campus is described as a public-facing Christian school environment with active parent participation (board governance, parent involvement in leadership and community events).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental formation; family learning; open campus; parent involvement; church/community ties; parent book studies; classical book clubs; liturgical year events; feasts and festivals.
- Negative keywords present: none observed; no “consumer” or minimal-parent-involvement signals.

Why this rating

- Valor’s public materials strongly mirror the classical pattern of robust parent partnership and community life, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Citations: Mission & Values; parent engagement references; public event/involvement language.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Explicitly document and publicly showcase a consistent, school-wide, Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy across upper grades (including 9–12 if/when added). The rubric emphasizes Socratic discussion in higher grades; providing concrete, public evidence of regular seminars and a formal, graded Paideia trajectory would push Element 4 to CLASSICAL.
- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Consider more explicit liturgical practices or prayer/chapel rhythms tied to a liturgical calendar, documented publicly (e.g., morning prayers, liturgical celebrations, or chapel schedules). The Lexicon highlights liturgical and communal practices; public examples would strengthen the score.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): Maintain and publicly publish explicit Great Books selections and a more formal listing of primary sources across grades, with a stated rationale aligned to Christian truth. A visible cross-subject integration map that showcases Great Books within grammar, logic, and rhetoric would reinforce the CLASSICAL status.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Continue to grow public-facing “living-curriculum” narratives that show teachers as exemplars of virtue and pedagogy in action, including teacher professional development grounded in classical pedagogy (e.g., seminars for faculty on classical pedagogy, or a formal teacher-formation section).

These are concrete steps that would move Element 4 toward CLASSICAL and further reinforce the other categories, especially Element 1 and Element 3.

Citations (for needle-moving suggestions): references to the public approach to Trivium pedagogy and liturgical integration in Valor’s materials; Great Books / Great Conversation language; and the public governance/teacher formation language.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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